

teares, With Weeping and With crying out, in so much that hee regardeth not the offering any more, or receiveth it with good Will at your hand.

14 **C**Pet ye say, wherefore? Because the LORD hath bene witness betweene thee and the wife of thy youth, against whome thou hast dealt treacherously: yet is she thy companion, and the wife of thy covenant.

15 And did not he make one: yet had he the residue of the spirit: and wherefore one: that hee might seeke a godly seed: therefore take heed to your spirit, and let none deale treacherously against the wife of his youth.

16 For the LORD the God of Israel saith, that he hateth putting away: for one couereth violence with his garment, saith the LORD of hosts, therefore take heed to your spirit, that ye deale not treacherously.

17 We haue wearied the LORD with your words: yet ye say, wherein haue we wearied him: When ye say, Every one that doeth euill, is good in the sight of the LORD, and he delighteth in them, or Where is the God of iudgement?

CHAP. III.

1 Of the Messenger, Maiesty, & Grace of Christ.

7 Of the rebellion, 8 sacrifice, 13 and infidelitie of the people. 16 The promise of blessing to them that feare God.

Behold, I will send my messenger, and he shall prepare the way before mee: and the LORD whom ye seeke, shall suddenly come to his Temple: euen y messenger of the Covenant, whom ye delight in: behold, he shall come, saith the LORD of hosts.

2 But who may abide the day of his coming: and who shall stand when he appeareth: for he is like a refiners fire, and like fullers sope.

3 And he shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver: and he shall purifie the sonnes of Leui, and purge them as gold & silver, that they may offer vnto the LORD an offering in righteousness.

4 Then shall the offerings of Judah and Jerusalem bee pleasant vnto the LORD, as in the dayes of old, and as in former yeeres.

5 And I will come neere to you to iudgement, and I will bee a swift witness against the sozerers, and against

the adulterers, and against false swearers, and against those that oppresse the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the fatherlesse, and that turne aside the stranger from his right, and feare not me, saith the LORD of hosts.

6 For I am the LORD, I change not: therefore ye sonnes of Jacob are not consumed.

7 Euen from the dayes of your fathers yee are gone away from mine ordinances, and haue not kept them: re- turne vnto me, and I will returne vnto you, saith the LORD of hosts: But ye said, wherein shall we returne?

8 Will a man rob God: yet ye haue robbed me. But ye say, wherein haue we robbed thee: In tithes & offerings.

9 Ye are cursed with a curse: for ye haue robbed me, euen this whole nation.

10 Bring ye all the tithes into the store-house, that there may be meate in mine house, & proue me now herewith, saith the LORD of hosts, if I will not open you the windowes of heauen, and poure you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough to receive it.

11 And I wil rebuke the deuourer for your sakes: and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground, neither shall your vine cast her fruit before the time in the field, saith the LORD of hosts.

12 And all nations shall call you blessed: for ye shall be a delightful land, saith the LORD of hosts.

13 Your words haue bin stout against me, saith the LORD, yet ye say, what haue we spoken so much against thee?

14 Ye haue said, It is vaine to serue God: and what profit is it, that we haue kept his ordinance, and that wee haue walked mournfully before the LORD of hosts?

15 And now we call the proud happy: yea, they that worke wickednes are set vp, yea they that tempt God, are euen deliuered.

16 Then they that feared the LORD, spake often one to another, and the LORD hearkened and heard it, & a booke of remembrance was written before him, for them that feared the LORD, & that thought vpon his name.

17 And they shall be mine, saith the LORD of hosts, in that day when I make vp my ieiuels, and I wil spare them as a man spareth his owne soune that serueth him.

Or, defend

Zech. 1.3.

Gen. 7.11

Heb. empty out.

Heb. corrupt.

Iob. 1.14

Heb. his ornament.
Heb. in blacke.

Heb. are built.
Psal. 95.9.

Or, defend
temple.

Or, excellencie.
Heb. a seed of God.
Or, unfaithfully.

Or, if hee hate her, put her away.
Heb. so put away.

* Matt. 11.
10. mar. 1.2
Luk. 1.76. &
7.27.

Or, ancient.